

Kolaa Hybrid Usage-Based Pricing Model

A Nigerian-first monetization model combining subscriptions, usage and value-based automation.

1. Executive recommendation

Do not choose between subscription and pay-as-you-go. Use a hybrid model. The subscription pays for access to Kolaa's platform, integrations, memory, analytics and an included usage allowance. Usage expands as Kolaa processes more business activity and performs more work.

The key principle is: Kolaa should grow financially as the customer's business grows.

2. Why this fits Nigeria

Many Nigerian businesses are comfortable paying transaction-linked fees because the cost is associated with activity or revenue. A software subscription can feel like another fixed bill. That does not mean subscriptions do not work. It means the subscription should be easy to justify and should not be the only monetization mechanism.

3. Recommended plans

Plan	Price	Target	Positioning
Free	₦0	Micro and new businesses	Basic intelligence and limited usage
Growth	₦15,000/mo	Growing SMEs	Core intelligence, integrations and automation
Pro	₦50,000/mo	Established businesses	Advanced automation, teams and analytics
Business	₦150,000+/mo	Larger/multi-location	Custom integrations, API and advanced controls
Pay-as-you-go	Low/no base	Irregular or price-sensitive	Continue using Kolaa based on metered activity

4. What the subscription pays for

The subscription should represent Kolaa's fixed platform value: dashboard access, business memory, standard integrations, analytics, knowledge management, team access, support level and a monthly usage allowance.

Capability	Growth	Pro
Users	2	10+
Native integrations	3	10+
AI interactions	2,000/mo	10,000/mo
Business events	5,000/mo	50,000/mo
Automation executions	500/mo	5,000/mo
History	90 days	1 year+
API	Limited	Full

5. What Kolaa should meter

Internally, Kolaa can measure tokens, API calls, events, retrieval operations and compute. Customers should see simple categories instead.

Meter	Internal meaning	Customer-facing name
Business events	Orders, payments, messages, inventory events, webhooks	Business activity
AI work	Reasoning, retrieval and model operations	AI usage
Automations	Successful workflow executions	Automations
External actions	Messages and API writes	Actions

Meter	Internal meaning	Customer-facing name
Storage	Documents and indexed knowledge	Knowledge storage

6. Overage model

Do not immediately force a customer to upgrade when they cross a limit. Allow pay-as-you-go overages. The exact prices should be calibrated after real usage and infrastructure costs are known.

Illustrative unit	Starting modelling range
1,000 additional business events	₦500 - ₦1,500
1,000 additional AI interactions	₦1,000 - ₦3,000
500 additional automation executions	₦1,000 - ₦2,500
1,000 additional external actions	₦1,000 - ₦3,000
Custom integration	Setup/quoted fee

7. The real monetization opportunity: actions

Kolaa becomes more valuable when it stops merely answering questions and starts doing approved work.

Example: Payment received → match customer → match order → update inventory → create delivery task → notify customer → update analytics → alert owner if stock is low.

This lets Kolaa monetize successful automation and business execution rather than simply charging for AI messages.

8. Example customer economics

Customer	Activity	Recommended spend
Small fashion seller	~300 orders/month	₦0 - ₦15k
Growing retailer	~2,000 orders/month	₦15k - ₦50k + usage
Large retailer	10,000+ orders/month	₦50k - ₦150k+ + usage
Multi-location company	Large team and many systems	₦150k+ / custom

9. Unit economics model

Track revenue per customer, infrastructure/model cost, gross margin and expansion revenue.

Illustrative example: a Growth customer pays ₦15,000 and costs ₦4,000 in direct infrastructure/model usage. That leaves ₦11,000 before other operating costs. If the same customer expands to ₦10,000 of additional usage, Kolaa's revenue grows without needing a new sales conversion.

The objective is not to maximize usage. It is to make usage correlate with customer value while maintaining healthy gross margins.

10. Payment infrastructure opportunity

Kolaa should initially use providers such as Paystack, Flutterwave, Monnify, Moniepoint and Fincra for payment infrastructure. Kolaa can ingest verified payment events and build intelligence around them.

Example: ₦250,000 payment → verified event → reconcile order → update inventory → trigger fulfillment → record revenue → recommend next action.

Do not take a percentage of customer payments merely because Kolaa can observe them. A transaction revenue model should only be introduced after the appropriate provider partnership, licensing and regulatory structure is established.

11. Keep billing simple for the customer

Do not expose an AWS-style usage console. Show: **Kolaa capacity: 82% used.** Then explain what that means: business events processed, automations executed and AI work performed.

When the customer approaches a limit, offer two clear options: **Upgrade** or **Continue with pay-as-you-go.**

12. Launch strategy

Phase 1: Free + Growth + Pro. Give enough included usage for customers to experience real value.

Phase 2: introduce pay-as-you-go overages after collecting real usage and cost data.

Phase 3: add Business and Enterprise contracts, custom integrations, higher API limits and dedicated infrastructure.

Phase 4: if Kolaa develops approved payment partnerships, evaluate transaction-linked revenue for specific payment products.

13. Investor story

The attractive part is not simply recurring SaaS revenue. It is **net revenue expansion** as Kolaa becomes more deeply embedded in a business.

Free → Subscription → Usage → Automation → Enterprise → Infrastructure.

14. Final recommendation

Start free. Pay when Kolaa creates more value. Keep subscriptions simple, bundle common usage into each plan, offer transparent overages, charge more for high-value automation and custom integrations, and avoid making AI tokens the customer-facing metric.